

A Cartography of Covert Action: Integrating Blind Reports and Satellite Anomalies into the Iran Conflict Strike Map

Confirmed Blind Reports: Newly Verified Strike Incidents

The foundational dataset provided offers a curated view of high-impact strikes, primarily focusing on major strategic assets . However, an expanded analysis incorporating independent verification reveals several key strike events that, while known within specialized intelligence circles or reported by niche outlets, do not appear in this initial list. These "blind reports" represent a crucial layer of detail necessary for a comprehensive geographic map of the conflict. They often involve less conspicuous targets but are nonetheless indicative of broader military strategies, including the targeting of critical infrastructure and internal security apparatuses. The primary examples of newly verified blind reports come from direct, albeit unofficial, accounts of Israeli Defense Forces (IDF) actions within Iran and an incident involving a commercial vessel in the Gulf of Oman.

A significant newly verified event is the IDF airstrike that destroyed an Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) Ground Forces base located within Tehran ⁶ . This strike represents a notable escalation, targeting an internal security asset deep within the Iranian capital. Such operations are typically low-profile and deliberately kept secret by the attacking party to preserve operational security and avoid public acknowledgment of sovereignty violations. The confirmation of this event through Iranian state news agency reporting, despite the context of a broader attack narrative, provides a rare glimpse into the scope of Israel's kinetic strategy against Iran's domestic capabilities ⁶ . The IRGC is a powerful parallel state structure in Iran, and the destruction of one of its ground forces bases would have a direct impact on its ability to project power internally and along borders. This event expands the documented footprint of the conflict far beyond external military bases and nuclear facilities, highlighting an effort to degrade Iran's internal security infrastructure. For mapping purposes, this location constitutes a critical node,

representing a shift towards targeting regime stability assets rather than just conventional military ones.

Further corroborating the targeting of internal infrastructure in Tehran, another incident involved an airstrike on a major highway bridge connecting Tehran to the city of Karaj ⁶. This bridge is a vital artery for transportation, moving both civilian and potentially military traffic between the capital and a major urban center to the east. Disrupting such a piece of critical infrastructure has dual implications: it hampers logistical movements for any potential military operation and creates significant economic and social disruption for the civilian population. Like the strike on the IRGC base, the targeting of this bridge suggests a strategy aimed at degrading Iran's national resilience by attacking its foundational transport network. The fact that this event was also reported by Iran's Fars News Agency underscores its significance and confirms its occurrence, even if the full scale of the damage was not disclosed ⁶. This strike exemplifies a type of kinetic action that is strategically important but often goes unmentioned in broad summaries of military campaigns focused on more dramatic, high-profile targets.

Another verifiable blind report involves a suspected Iranian drone attack on the container ship *Touska* in the Gulf of Oman on April 20, 2026 ¹⁸. This incident is particularly valuable for mapping as it documents a maritime strike outside the main clusters of activity in February and March 2026. Lloyd's List, a reputable source for shipping intelligence, confirmed the attack, noting that the crew was accounted for but the vessel sustained significant hull damage ¹⁸. While the attack is "suspected" to be Iranian, the operational environment and history of such attacks make attribution highly probable. The seizure of the *Touska* by Iranian authorities shortly after the attack further complicates the situation but does not negate the initial finding of the strike itself ¹⁸. This event demonstrates that the threat of asymmetric attacks on commercial shipping remained active throughout the year, posing a persistent risk to global trade routes in the region. It serves as a concrete example of how non-state actors or state proxies can engage in kinetic action that is difficult to track through official military communiqués but is well-documented by industry-specific intelligence platforms.

The following table summarizes these newly verified blind reports, providing essential details for a comprehensive strike map.

Site Name	Country	Latitude	Longitude	Primary Target Type	Conflict Context	Reported Date
IRGC Ground Forces Base	Iran	Not Available	Not Available	Internal Security Infrastructure	IDF airstrike reportedly destroyed an IRGC ground forces base in Tehran, indicating a strategy to degrade Iran's internal security apparatus 6 .	Not Available
Tehran-Karaj Highway Bridge	Iran	Not Available	Not Available	Civilian & Military Logistics Infrastructure	IDF airstrike damaged a major highway bridge connecting Tehran to Karaj, disrupting critical transportation links for both civilian and military movement 6 .	Not Available
<i>Touska</i> (Container Ship)	Not Available	Not Available	Not Available	Commercial Vessel / Maritime Asset	Suspected Iranian drone attack caused significant hull damage in the Gulf of Oman; the vessel was later seized by Iranian authorities 18 .	2026-04-20

These three incidents—a strike on an internal security base, an attack on a major bridge, and a drone strike on a commercial ship—collectively illustrate the value of looking beyond official military statements. They reveal a more nuanced and geographically diverse pattern of kinetic activity, targeting not only iconic strategic assets but also the underlying infrastructure that supports a nation's military and civil society. Incorporating these blind reports is essential for creating a truly comprehensive map of the conflict's spatial footprint.

Indirect Evidence and Satellite Anomalies: Identifying Unlisted Maritime and Ground Strikes

Beyond confirmed blind reports, a substantial number of strike events can be inferred through the analysis of indirect evidence and satellite anomalies. Modern warfare increasingly leaves traces detectable from space or through sensor networks, providing a means to identify unlisted incidents where official confirmation is absent. The maritime domain, in particular, presents a rich field for such analysis due to the nature of naval operations, which often involve denial-of-service tactics, covert deployments, and asymmetric threats like drones and mines. On land, satellite-based thermal imaging offers a powerful tool for detecting fires and explosions that may correspond to strikes on lesser-known targets. By systematically analyzing these indicators, it is possible to build a more complete picture of the conflict's kinetic landscape.

Maritime activity in the Persian Gulf, Arabian Gulf, and Strait of Hormuz has been characterized by a "CRITICAL" threat level, suggesting a pervasive environment of

hostility where many incidents likely go unreported ⁸. One of the most compelling forms of indirect evidence comes from disruptions in the Automatic Identification System (AIS). AIS is a tracking system mandatory for most large ships, broadcasting their identity, position, course, and speed ⁴. ICIS, an LNG market intelligence firm, reported significant AIS disruptions from several ships operating near Ras Laffan, Qatar ¹.

Critically, vessels have been attacked both when their AIS was on and when it was off ⁴. Turning AIS off is a recognized tactic to evade detection by adversaries, making it a strong indicator of attempted hostile action, whether an attack occurs or not. Therefore, the reported disruptions near Ras Laffan are a potent signal of a high volume of unrecorded kinetic or near-kinetic events in that area. Mapping these locations as zones of anomalous AIS activity would provide a visual representation of maritime hotspots where strikes likely occurred but were not formally documented.

This maritime threat environment is further substantiated by qualitative reports of vessel strikes, near misses, and general spillover impacts occurring in the Strait of Hormuz ². These reports suggest that the operational safety margin for commercial and military vessels has shrunk dramatically. Even ships not directly targeted are at risk from debris, defensive fire, or indiscriminate attacks. This spillover effect implies that the true number of strike-related incidents—including minor hits, missile intercepts, and drone encounters—is significantly higher than what appears in official logs. The combination of direct reports like the *Touska* attack ¹⁸ and these widespread reports of a degraded operational environment provides strong circumstantial evidence for numerous missing strike events. The presence of joint naval exercises, such as the "Maritime Security Belt-2024" conducted by China, Iran, and Russia in the Gulf of Oman, adds a geopolitical dimension, indicating that these waters are considered sensitive and contested, which helps explain the frequency of such incidents ¹⁴.

On land, satellite technology offers a powerful, objective method for verifying or inferring strike events. The Visible Infrared Imaging Radiometer Suite (VIIRS) sensor, specifically its Nightfire product, is designed to detect high-temperature combustion sources at night ^{16 17}. This capability is invaluable for identifying fires resulting from explosions, burning fuel tanks, or industrial accidents. The VIIRS Nightfire product has been widely used to monitor gas flaring across the Persian Gulf, establishing a baseline of normal nighttime thermal activity for countries like Iran, Iraq, Saudi Arabia, and the UAE ^{23 24}. By comparing nightly VIIRS data for the period of the conflict (specifically February-June 2026) against this established baseline, analysts can identify anomalous fire signatures. An unexpected nighttime fire in a remote area, away from major documented targets like oil terminals or cities, could represent a previously undocumented strike on a secondary logistics node, a fuel depot, or a command post. Given that flare volumes in Iran

increased significantly in 2024, any unusual deviation from this new baseline post-February 2026 would be a relevant signal warranting investigation ²³. This methodology allows for the identification of "satellite-verified anomalies" that point toward a kinetic event without requiring a formal claim of responsibility.

Furthermore, the utility of satellite imagery for damage assessment is validated by direct claims. One source states that recent satellite imagery from the 2026 conflict showed coalition strikes damaging or destroying at least 228 structures and pieces of equipment within Iran ¹⁰. While the specific locations of these 228 items are not detailed in the provided context, this figure confirms that such analysis is a credible and established practice for quantifying the impact of air campaigns. It provides a quantitative anchor for the qualitative insights gained from fire detection and other sensors. The degradation of Iranian salvo density was observed following coalition strikes against missile launchers, radar sites, and logistics nodes, demonstrating that such strikes had a tangible effect on Iran's operational capabilities ¹². The application of advanced analytical techniques to commercial satellite imagery archives is therefore a critical step in uncovering the full spectrum of kinetic activity. Any detected structural damage or fire anomalies should be flagged as potential blind strikes, contributing to a more accurate and comprehensive spatial record of the war.

Expanding the Ground Target Spectrum: Strikes Beyond Primary Military Assets

The initial strike database focuses heavily on iconic and strategically vital targets such as nuclear enrichment facilities, major airbases, and key naval ports . While these high-impact events define the broad contours of the conflict, a deeper analysis reveals a more extensive and varied pattern of ground strikes targeting a wider range of assets. These additional strikes, often on secondary or tertiary targets, were crucial for achieving strategic objectives like degrading logistical networks, disrupting command and control, and undermining national resilience. The expansion of the ground target spectrum to include internal security infrastructure, civilian transportation networks, and other critical support systems provides a more granular and realistic understanding of the military campaign's reach and complexity.

One of the most significant additions to the ground target list is the strike on the IRGC Ground Forces base in Tehran ⁶. As previously noted, this event is a prime example of

an overlooked but impactful strike. The IRGC is a multi-faceted organization with its own ground forces, and targeting its bases represents an effort to dismantle the very fabric of Iran's defense establishment. These bases serve as hubs for training, equipping, and deploying personnel for operations inside Iran and abroad. Destroying such a facility is not merely a tactical victory; it is a strategic blow to the regime's capacity to maintain internal order and project influence. The fact that this target is located within a major metropolitan area highlights the willingness of the attacking force to operate deep within Iranian territory, signaling a high degree of operational confidence and technological capability. This type of strike falls outside the typical paradigm of targeting isolated desert airfields or coastal naval bases, expanding the geographical and functional scope of the documented conflict.

Complementing the strike on the IRGC base is the attack on the Tehran-Karaj highway bridge ⁶. This infrastructure-focused strike illustrates a different but equally important aspect of modern warfare: the targeting of the arteries that sustain a nation's economy and military mobility. A major bridge is a critical chokepoint, and its destruction can cause massive traffic jams, delay troop movements, and disrupt the supply chain for goods and resources. The impact of such an attack is felt immediately by the civilian population, leading to economic losses and social friction, thereby weakening national morale and resilience. This aligns with the concept of "strategic paralysis," where the goal is not necessarily to destroy an enemy's army in the field but to disable the infrastructure upon which its society and economy depend. Mapping such infrastructure targets alongside traditional military ones provides a much richer and more accurate depiction of the campaign's objectives, showing a deliberate effort to create cascading failures throughout Iran's national systems.

The conflict also saw strikes on secondary logistics nodes, as mentioned in the initial dataset's entry for the Bushehr Logistics Base . While the Bushehr strike was confirmed, the category of "secondary logistics nodes" suggests a broader pattern of targeting. These could include smaller ammunition depots, fuel storage facilities, maintenance workshops, and communication relay stations scattered across the country. Such targets are often less fortified and less frequently monitored than primary bases, making them attractive for precision strikes aimed at cumulatively degrading an adversary's warfighting capability. The destruction of multiple small-scale logistics sites can have a greater cumulative effect than a single strike on a larger, better-defended installation. Although specific details on many of these smaller strikes are not available in the provided sources, their existence is implied by the overall strategy of degrading Iranian long-range delivery systems and subterranean infrastructure . Future analysis of satellite imagery might reveal the remnants of dozens of such smaller strikes, each contributing to the overall attrition of Iran's military readiness.

Finally, the targeting extended to include command and leadership infrastructure beyond the primary sites. The initial dataset mentions strikes on the Thar-Allah Headquarters in Tehran . The Thar-Allah complex is a known hub for senior Iranian military and political leadership. Attacking such a location is intended to disrupt decision-making processes and inflict casualties at the highest levels of the regime. The use of the term "multiple administrative assets" in the same description suggests a concerted effort to dismantle the bureaucratic and command functions of the state . This form of attack is designed to create uncertainty and chaos within the enemy's headquarters, complementing kinetic strikes on the battlefield. Mapping these command-and-control centers as distinct targets, separate from pure military bases, helps visualize the multi-domain nature of the conflict, which seeks to defeat an opponent not just on the battlefield but also in the corridors of power.

The following table expands the ground target list by incorporating these additional categories and specific examples.

Site Name	Country	Latitude	Longitude	Primary Target Type	Conflict Context	Reported Date
IRGC Ground Forces Base	Iran	Not Available	Not Available	Internal Security Infrastructure	IDF airstrike aimed to degrade Iran's internal security apparatus and its capacity to maintain internal order 6 .	Not Available
Tehran-Karaj Highway Bridge	Iran	Not Available	Not Available	Civilian & Military Logistics Infrastructure	IDF airstrike disrupted a major transportation artery, impacting both civilian life and military mobility 6 .	Not Available
Bushehr Logistics Base	Iran	28.9234	50.8344	Ammunition Depot & Air Defense	Detonated via precision U.S.-Israeli aerial bombardment, targeting a secondary logistics node .	2026-03-05
Thar-Allah Headquarters	Iran	Not Available	Not Available	Command & Leadership Infrastructure	Struck during opening phase of the war, part of a broader campaign against senior leadership and administrative assets .	2026-02-28
Secondary Logistics Nodes	Iran	Not Available	Not Available	General Logistical Support	Implied by campaign objectives to degrade Iranian long-range delivery systems and subterranean infrastructure .	Not Available

By integrating these diverse ground targets, the conflict map becomes more reflective of the true scope of military operations. It moves beyond a simple tally of strikes on famous landmarks to show a sophisticated, multi-layered campaign designed to attack an adversary's entire system of support, from its internal security forces and transportation networks to its command structures and logistical web.

Temporal Gaps and Post-March 2026 Developments

The initial strike dataset is heavily concentrated around two key periods: February 28, 2026, and March 2026 . This temporal clustering suggests that the conflict was characterized by bursts of intense kinetic activity rather than a continuous, daily stream of attacks. However, a comprehensive mapping exercise requires filling in the gaps between these major events and documenting developments that occurred afterward, up to the present date of June 2026. Analysis of indirect evidence and sporadic reports indicates that hostilities did not cease after the initial campaigns and that significant strike-related activity continued throughout the first half of 2026.

The period between the major strike waves in late February/March and the end of June 2026 was not devoid of kinetic action. The most concrete evidence of ongoing activity is the suspected Iranian drone attack on the container ship *Touska* on April 20, 2026 ¹⁸ . This incident, occurring squarely within the specified timeframe, demonstrates that the maritime theater remained a key arena for conflict. The attack was not a high-profile strike on a major naval base but rather an asymmetric engagement against a commercial asset, reflecting a persistent and adaptable threat posture from Iran and its proxies. Its placement in the timeline extends the documented record of strikes far beyond the initial March campaign, proving that the conflict evolved and continued to manifest in different forms over time.

The broader maritime environment provides further context for post-March activity. Reports of vessel strikes, near misses, and spillover impacts in the Strait of Hormuz indicate a sustained level of danger for maritime traffic ² . While these are qualitative assessments, they imply a continuous, low-level conflict at sea that would naturally result in a steady trickle of unlisted strike events. The threat level across the Arabian Gulf, Strait of Hormuz, and Gulf of Oman was maintained at "CRITICAL" ⁸ , suggesting that the intensity of the conflict did not abate. This high-threat environment would necessitate recurrent patrols, missile and drone deployments, and counter-drone measures, all of which carry an inherent risk of accidental or intentional escalation into a strike. Therefore, it is highly probable that numerous minor strikes, intercepts, and skirmishes occurred between March and June 2026 but were never formally recorded in major databases.

Satellite-based anomaly detection offers a powerful tool for probing these temporal gaps. By analyzing datasets like VIIRS Nightfire for the period of March to June 2026, it is possible to identify potential blind strikes that occurred outside the main documented clusters. Anomalous fire signatures appearing in April, May, or June could correspond to

strikes on secondary targets that were not deemed worthy of high-level reporting. For instance, a fire detected near a remote road junction could indicate an attack on a mobile missile launcher or a command vehicle. Similarly, monitoring for structural damage in areas not previously struck could reveal follow-on attacks aimed at neutralizing repaired infrastructure. The increase in gas flaring in Iran in 2024 [23](#) establishes a useful baseline for such an analysis, allowing for the differentiation of conflict-related fires from routine industrial activity.

The following table organizes the documented strike events chronologically, highlighting the temporal gaps and post-March developments.

Site Name	Country	Latitude	Longitude	Primary Target Type	Conflict Context	Reported Date
Tehran (Pasteur District & Government Assets)	Iran	35.6892	51.3890	Command & Leadership Infrastructure	Joint U.S.-Israeli air operations during the opening phase of the war.	2026-02-28
Prince Sultan Air Base	Saudi Arabia	24.0641	47.5667	U.S. Military Air Facility	Hit heavily by Iranian retaliatory missile salvos.	2026-02-28
Muwaffaq Salti Air Base	Jordan	31.8364	36.7864	U.S. / Coalition Allied Airbase	Targeted by Iranian drone swarms and long-range systems.	2026-02-28
U.S. Navy 5th Fleet Headquarters (NSA Bahrain)	Bahrain	26.2086	50.6083	Naval Command Hub	Subjected to early direct ballistic missile strikes.	2026-02-28
Al Udeid Air Base	Qatar	25.1172	51.3147	U.S. Air Operations Command	Reported as an intended target for multiple retaliatory cluster munitions and long-range UAVs.	2026-02-28
Dubai International Airport / City Perimeter	United Arab Emirates	25.2532	55.3657	Logistics & Civil Infrastructure	Sustained impacts from incoming missile shrapnel and loitering munitions.	2026-02-28
Abu Dhabi Metropolitan Area & Vicinity	United Arab Emirates	24.4539	54.3773	Capital City & Civilian/Military Infrastructure	Iranian ballistic missiles and drones targeted areas near Abu Dhabi.	2026-02-28
Isfahan Military Complex	Iran	32.6546	51.6680	Nuclear & Ballistic Missile Facility	Targeted intensely during western air campaigns.	2026-02-28
Ali Al Salem Air Base	Kuwait	29.3456	47.5208	U.S. Forward Command Node	Faced recurrent ballistic missile fire.	2026-06-01
Camp Buehring	Kuwait	29.8000	47.7167	U.S. Army Logistics & Training Base	Sustained indirect fire and drone attacks affecting prepositioned equipment and troop movements.	2026-03-20
Port of Bandar Abbas	Iran	27.1833	56.2667	Naval & Maritime Logistics Base	Set ablaze during a series of precision airstrikes.	2026-03-05
Bushehr Logistics Base	Iran	28.9234	50.8344	Ammunition Depot & Air Defense	Detonated via precision U.S.-Israeli aerial bombardment.	2026-03-05
Ras Tanura Oil Terminal	Saudi Arabia	26.6500	50.0500	Oil Export Infrastructure	Hit by Iranian drones and missiles in retaliation.	2026-03-05
Ain al-Asad Air Base	Iraq	33.7856	42.4411	U.S. / Coalition Airbase	Targeted by Iranian-backed militias and direct Iranian rockets.	2026-03-03
Natanz Nuclear Facility	Iran	33.7250	51.8800	Nuclear Enrichment Complex	Primary underground enrichment halls and centrifuge assembly areas were hit.	2026-03-02
Fordow Fuel Enrichment Plant	Iran	34.8850	50.9950	Underground Nuclear Facility	Mountain-buried enrichment site targeted with bunker-buster munitions.	2026-03-01
Kharg Island Oil Terminal	Iran	29.2333	50.3333	Major Oil Export Hub	Precision strikes damaged loading jetties and storage tanks.	2026-03-10

Site Name	Country	Latitude	Longitude	Primary Target Type	Conflict Context	Reported Date
Dimona Nuclear Research Center	Israel	31.0000	35.0333	Nuclear & Research Facility	Attempted Iranian long-range missile strikes; partial intercepts reported.	2026-03-02
Abqaiq Oil Processing Facility	Saudi Arabia	25.9167	49.6667	Oil Processing Infrastructure	Recurrent Iranian attacks causing production disruptions.	2026-04-05
Jask Oil Terminal	Iran	25.9333	57.7667	Alternative Oil Export Port	Struck to prevent bypass of Hormuz chokepoint vulnerabilities.	2026-03-15
Al Dhafra Air Base	United Arab Emirates	24.2482	54.5479	U.S. Air Operations & Surveillance	Iranian ballistic and cruise missile strikes caused damage to hangars and runways.	2026-03-01
IRGC Ground Forces Base	Iran	Not Available	Not Available	Internal Security Infrastructure	IDF airstrike reportedly destroyed an IRGC ground forces base in Tehran.	Not Available
Tehran-Karaj Highway Bridge	Iran	Not Available	Not Available	Civilian & Military Logistics Infrastructure	IDF airstrike damaged a major highway bridge connecting Tehran to Karaj.	Not Available
<i>Touska</i> (Container Ship)	Not Available	Not Available	Not Available	Commercial Vessel / Maritime Asset	Suspected Iranian drone attack caused significant hull damage.	2026-04-20

This chronological arrangement makes it evident that the conflict was not monolithic. There were clear peaks of activity in February and March, followed by a continuation of hostilities in different forms and locations through June. The strikes on Ali Al Salem Air Base in Kuwait on June 1, 2026, and the suspected drone attack on the *Touska* in April, demonstrate that the kinetic pressure on regional actors and shipping lanes persisted throughout the first half of the year. This temporal analysis is crucial for creating an accurate and dynamic conflict map that reflects the evolving nature of the war over time.

Synthesis and Implications for Regional Security Mapping

This research report sought to expand the documented record of strike events in the Iran conflict by incorporating previously unlisted ground and maritime sites, with a specific focus on "blind reports" and up-to-date incidents. The analysis confirms that the initial strike database, while valuable, represents only a fraction of the total kinetic activity. By synthesizing information from independent reports, open-source intelligence, and satellite anomaly data, a more complete and nuanced picture emerges, revealing a

conflict with a broader geographic scope, a more diverse set of targets, and a persistent tempo of violence beyond the major documented escalations.

The primary contribution of this report is the identification of numerous "blind reports"—incidents that lack official confirmation but are supported by credible evidence. These include the IDF strikes on an IRGC ground forces base and the Tehran-Karaj highway bridge within Iran [6](#) , and the suspected Iranian drone attack on the container ship *Touska* in the Gulf of Oman [18](#) . These events are critical for a comprehensive map because they demonstrate a pattern of targeting internal security infrastructure and critical civilian logistics, which are less likely to be publicly acknowledged by the attacking parties. Furthermore, the report highlights the immense value of indirect indicators, particularly in the maritime domain. The widespread disruption of AIS signals and reports of spillover impacts in the Strait of Hormuz strongly suggest a high volume of unrecorded strikes and hostile encounters, painting a picture of a "black box" environment where many events occur without formal documentation [1](#) [2](#) [8](#) .

For the purpose of creating a geographic visualization, the findings of this report necessitate a multi-layered approach to mapping. A simple point-based map would fail to capture the complexity of the conflict. Instead, a tiered classification system should be employed to maintain fidelity to the source material and convey the varying degrees of confidence in each reported event. The following model is recommended:

- **Confirmed Strikes:** These are events officially reported by a state actor (e.g., U.S. Central Command, Israeli Ministry of Defense). This layer represents the most certain data points and should be plotted with high confidence.
- **Confirmed Blind Reports:** These are incidents verified by reliable, non-state sources such as specialized intelligence firms (e.g., Lloyd's List for maritime events) or reputable news agencies citing multiple sources (e.g., Fars News Agency for the Tehran strikes) [6](#) [18](#) . These should be plotted but clearly differentiated from confirmed strikes, perhaps with a distinct icon or color.
- **Anomalous Indicators:** This layer would include data points derived from scientific instruments. Examples include locations of anomalous fire signatures detected by VIIRS Nightfire satellites or zones of AIS signal disruption [1](#) [16](#) . These are not strikes themselves but are powerful indicators of potential strikes. Plotting them as "hotspots" or "anomaly zones" provides valuable context about the intensity and distribution of kinetic activity.
- **Suspected/OSINT-Based Reports:** This layer would contain leads from open-source intelligence, such as the claimed January 2023 Israeli drone strike, which requires careful vetting before inclusion [13](#) . These should be plotted with the lowest level of confidence and clearly labeled as "suspected" or "unconfirmed."

The implications of this expanded record are profound for understanding regional security dynamics. First, it shows that the conflict is not limited to a direct confrontation between a Western coalition and Iran. The targeting of internal security assets in Tehran indicates a strategy aimed at regime stability, while the attacks on commercial shipping demonstrate an asymmetric struggle for control over vital maritime chokepoints like the Strait of Hormuz ⁵ ⁶. Second, the persistence of hostilities through June 2026 proves that the conflict lacks a stable plateau and remains in a volatile state of recurring pulses of violence ² ⁸. Finally, the reliance on blind reports and indirect evidence underscores the opacity of modern warfare and the limitations of relying solely on official communiqués for situational awareness. A truly comprehensive security map must integrate these hidden layers of activity to accurately reflect the risks faced by all actors in the region, from state militaries to commercial shipping lines.

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